

ELEARNING STORYBOARD

The Coaching Conversation: Navigating a Performance Conversation

Rise 360 Branching Scenario | Articulate 360

Designer: Joshua Zink

Platform: Articulate Rise 360

Audience: People managers; L&D/OD practitioners (portfolio)

Format: Branching scenario with Multiple Choice Knowledge Checks

Lessons: 5

Screens: 9 (4 text blocks + 4 knowledge checks + 1 text-only conclusion)

Course URL: https://rise.articulate.com/authoring/_rBbuB-elxmD14FOdimRygxsSeUX2dcl

Characters: Alex Rivera (learner / manager), Jordan (direct report)

Scenario: Jordan missed the Meridian client deliverable on Friday -- first offense.

Design model: Scenario-based learning, Merrill's First Principles

STORYBOARD LEGEND

Screen #: Lesson number . Screen number within lesson (e.g., 2.1 = Lesson 2, Screen 1).

Type: TEXT BLOCK or KNOWLEDGE CHECK (KC). Text blocks deliver scenario narrative. KCs are Multiple Choice interactions.

Title / Heading: The visible heading text displayed on screen.

On-Screen Text: Verbatim body copy shown in the text block, or verbatim question stem for KCs.

Interaction Details: KC only. Lists Choice A, B, and C verbatim. The correct answer is marked with (CORRECT).

Feedback: KC only. Correct feedback and Incorrect feedback shown after the learner submits.

Settings: KC settings: Reveal Correct Answer, Require Correct, Retries.

Visual / Dev Notes: Layout guidance, block type in Rise 360, asset notes, and developer instructions.

Shading Key:

Sample	Lesson header banner (dark navy with white text)
Sample	Column header row (blue-gray background)
Sample	Text Block screen row (white background)
Sample	Correct answer feedback cell (light green)
Sample	Incorrect answer feedback cell (light amber)

SCREEN #	TYPE	TITLE / HEADING	ON-SCREEN TEXT / QUESTION	INTERACTION DETAILS (Choices A / B / C)	FEEDBACK (Correct / Incorrect)	SETTINGS	VISUAL / DEV NOTES
LESSON 1: INTRODUCTION: THE SITUATION							
1.1	TEXT BLOCK	Meet Jordan	You are Alex Rivera, a manager on a client services team. Your direct report, Jordan, missed the Meridian client deliverable last Friday. The client noticed. Your director noticed. Now you need to have a conversation. Jordan has been on your team for two years. This is the first time a deadline has slipped. Their track record is strong. Before you say anything, you need to decide: how are you going to approach this conversation?	(No interaction -- narrative text block)	(No feedback)	N/A	Rise 360 Text block. Block order: Heading (H2) + Body paragraph. No images or media. Learner clicks Continue to advance to 1.2.
1.2	KNOWLEDGE CHECK (Multiple Choice)	(Knowledge Check -- no separate heading)	Before you meet with Jordan, how do you prepare?	A: Pull Jordan's recent work, note this is a first offense, and schedule a private 1:1 to understand what happened. [CORRECT] B: Send Jordan an email asking them to explain in writing what happened with the Meridian deliverable. C: Walk over to Jordan's desk and ask them directly what happened in front of the rest of the team.	CORRECT: Good instinct. Reviewing the context first helps you enter the conversation informed rather than reactive. Scheduling a private conversation protects Jordan's dignity and sets a coaching tone before the meeting starts. INCORRECT: That approach skips the preparation and the private setting that a coaching conversation requires. A coaching mindset begins before the conversation does -- with context, not confrontation.	Feedback type: Correct / Incorrect Reveal correct answer: ON Require correct: OFF Retries: Unlimited	Rise 360 Knowledge Check block. Multiple Choice, 3 options. Choice A is pre-marked correct in Rise KC block (default). Learner clicks Submit, sees feedback, then Continue.

LESSON 2: THE OPENING: STARTING THE CONVERSATION							
2.1	TEXT BLOCK	The Meeting Begins	It is 10 AM. Jordan walks into your office and takes a seat. You can tell they are tense. They know why they are here. This is the first time you have had to address a performance issue with Jordan. This is not a disciplinary conversation. It is a coaching conversation. The difference is everything: your tone, your opening question, and the direction you take from here. How you open this conversation will determine whether Jordan feels safe enough to tell you the truth.	(No interaction -- narrative text block)	(No feedback)	N/A	Rise 360 Text block. Block order: Heading (H2) + Body paragraphs. No images or media. Key concept introduced: coaching vs. disciplinary framing.
2.2	KNOWLEDGE CHECK (Multiple Choice)	(Knowledge Check -- no separate heading)	You want to start with curiosity, not conclusions. How do you open the conversation with Jordan?	A: Start with a calm, open-ended question: 'I wanted to check in with you about the Meridian deliverable. Can you walk me through what happened on Friday?' [CORRECT] B: Jump straight to the problem: 'The client is upset and my director is on my case. What went wrong with the Meridian deliverable?'	CORRECT: Well done. Starting with a genuine, open-ended question invites Jordan to share rather than defend, and establishes a coaching tone from the start. INCORRECT: That approach is likely to put Jordan on the defensive. Effective coaching conversations start with curiosity and an open question, not urgency or consequences.	Feedback type: Correct / Incorrect Reveal correct answer: ON Require correct: OFF Retries: Unlimited	Rise 360 Knowledge Check block. Multiple Choice, 3 options. Choice A pre-marked correct. Core skill: open-ended question as coaching opener.

				C: Open with an explanation of consequences: 'I need to tell you that this missed deadline is now on your record and could affect your performance rating.'			
LESSON 3: THE CORE: UNCOVERING WHAT HAPPENED							
3.1	TEXT BLOCK	Digging Deeper	Jordan opens up. They explain that Friday was chaotic: three competing deadlines, an emergency call from another stakeholder, and the Meridian deliverable slipped. Jordan looks frustrated with themselves. You can tell this is not a pattern. It is a moment. Now the real coaching begins. What do you do with what you just heard?	(No interaction -- narrative text block)	(No feedback)	N/A	Rise 360 Text block. Block order: Heading (H2) + Body paragraphs. Short, punchy block. Pause before the KC. Core concept: listening before leading.
3.2	KNOWLEDGE CHECK (Multiple Choice)	(Knowledge Check -- no separate heading)	Jordan says: 'I honestly just got pulled in too many directions at once. I'm really sorry.' How do you respond?	A: Acknowledge what you heard and ask a coaching question: 'It sounds like you were dealing with a lot at once. What do you think could have helped you catch this earlier?' [CORRECT] B: Move to problem-solving immediately: 'Okay, so next time just drop everything else and focus on the top priority deliverable until it is	CORRECT: Good instinct. Acknowledging first shows you heard Jordan, then asking a coaching question helps develop self-awareness and ownership rather than just a promise to do better. INCORRECT: Jumping to solutions or minimizing the situation skips the coaching moment. Reflect back what you heard, then invite Jordan to think	Feedback type: Correct / Incorrect Reveal correct answer: ON Require correct: OFF Retries: Unlimited	Rise 360 Knowledge Check block. Multiple Choice, 3 options. Choice A pre-marked correct. Core skill: acknowledge-then-coach sequence.

				done.' C: Reassure and close: 'I appreciate you being honest. It happens. Just make sure this doesn't happen again and we'll move on.'	through it with you.		
LESSON 4: THE PATH FORWARD: COMMITMENT AND CLOSE							
4.1	TEXT BLOCK	Moving Forward Together	The conversation is shifting. Jordan has reflected, taken ownership, and is now engaged. You have acknowledged what happened and explored the root cause. Now it is time to close the loop: agree on a specific path forward, reinforce your confidence in Jordan, and leave them feeling supported. How you close this conversation matters as much as how you opened it.	<i>(No interaction -- narrative text block)</i>	<i>(No feedback)</i>	N/A	Rise 360 Text block. Block order: Heading (H2) + Body paragraphs. Signals the transition from uncovering to committing. Sets up the final KC decision point.
4.2	KNOWLEDGE CHECK (Multiple Choice)	<i>(Knowledge Check -- no separate heading)</i>	Jordan has reflected and taken responsibility. You are ready to close the conversation. What is the best way to wrap up?	A: Agree on a specific action together: 'Let's put a standing flag in place so if you're ever stretched thin again, you reach out before a deadline slips. Does that work for you?' Then affirm Jordan's ownership and close with confidence. [CORRECT] B: End with a warning: 'I'm glad we talked, but I	CORRECT: Exactly. Closing with a concrete agreement and a genuine affirmation reinforces accountability without undermining trust. The conversation ends on a note of partnership. INCORRECT: A coaching conversation that ends with a threat or a dismissal loses the ground you gained. The close should reinforce ownership and confidence, not	Feedback type: Correct / Incorrect Reveal correct answer: ON Require correct: OFF Retries: Unlimited	Rise 360 Knowledge Check block. Multiple Choice, 3 options. Choice A pre-marked correct. Core skill: specific agreement + affirmation close.

				need you to understand that another miss like this will have real consequences for your standing on the team.' C: Keep it brief: 'Okay, good talk. Just make sure it doesn't happen again. You're dismissed.'	fear.		
LESSON 5: THE OUTCOME							
5.1	TEXT BLOCK	What You Did Well	You navigated this conversation the way a skilled coach does: with curiosity before conclusions, context before consequences, and commitment before closure. You opened with a question, not a verdict. You listened before you led. You helped Jordan think rather than just telling them what to do. And you closed with a specific agreement and a clear expression of confidence. That is what coaching leadership looks like in practice. The conversation with Jordan is over. But the skills you practiced here apply to every difficult conversation you will lead going forward. The more you lead with curiosity, the	<i>(No interaction -- narrative text block)</i>	<i>(No feedback)</i>	N/A	Rise 360 Text block. TEXT ONLY -- no KC. Block order: Heading (H2) + Body paragraphs (4). This is an integration screen, not an assessment. No Continue button required after this screen. DESIGN NOTE: Absence of a KC here is intentional. Reflects Merrill's 'Integration' stage.

			stronger your relationships and your team will become.				
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